

Surili Sheth

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Academic Position

ETH Zurich

Oct. 2025–Present

ETH Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences (D-GESS)

Education

University of California, Berkeley

2025

Ph.D. in Political Science

Dissertation: *The Politics of Disclosure: Three Papers on the Dynamics of Domestic Violence Claim-Making in India*

Committee: Pradeep Chhibber and Thad Dunning (co-chairs), Cecilia Mo, and Jennifer Bussell

University of California, Berkeley

2020

M.A. in Political Science

Harvard Kennedy School

2015

Master in Public Administration/International Development (MPA/ID)

The Ohio State University

2011

B.S. in Economics (Honors) and Political Science (Honors), summa cum laude; Minor in Mathematics

Research Interests

Comparative Politics; Legal Institutions; Legal Mobilization; Violence; Gender and Inequality; Immigration; South Asia; United States; Methods

Job Market Paper

The Dependency Trap: Domestic Violence and Claim-Making in India

Presented at: EGEN Stanford (2026); PolMeth Europe (2026); EMPESA Oslo (2026); EGEN Bergen (2026); EPSS Belfast (2026)

Working Papers

Missing and Miscoded Women: Measuring Domestic Violence Claims and Institutional Choice

Presented at: WPSA (2026); MPSA (2026)

Do Virtual Museums Highlighting the Experiences of Minorities Persuade Visitors? Evidence from a Study on Bias Toward Asian Americans

With Charles Crabtree, John B. Holbein, and Cecilia Mo. *Under review.* Available on SSRN.

Forever Foreign? Differential Linguistic Assimilation Standards for Asian Immigrants

With Charles Crabtree, John B. Holbein, and Cecilia Mo.

Commonality or Difference? Sexual Assault and the Foundations of Women's Solidarities in the United States

Works in Progress

Substitution Within Carceral Systems: Local Prison Capacity, Sanctuary Cities, and Immigrant Detention in the United States

Rooted in Rights: Women's Bargaining Power on Forest Land

With Bhumi Purohit and Rashi Sabherwal.

A Room of One's Own: Physical Infrastructure, Identity, and Access to Justice in Rural North India

With Anjali Bohlken and Debabrata Samanta.

Reviews, Policy Reports, and Other Writing

Women's Economic Empowerment in Pakistan: An Evidence-Guided Toolkit for More Inclusive Policies
With Sofia Amaral, Pulkit Aggarwal, Anusha Guha, Osama Safeer, and Shirleen Manzur. South Asia Gender Innovation Lab, World Bank, 2024. Report.

Book review of *Performing Representation: Women Members in the Indian Parliament*, by Shirin M. Rai and Carole Spary, and *Women, Power, and Property: The Paradox of Gender Equality Laws in India*, by Rachel E. Brulé

Seminar, no. 752, "She Rules!" (April 2022).

Seeing Like the State or Seeing the State? The Political Economy of Women's Self-Help Groups in Madhya Pradesh

With Arundhita Bhanjdeo, Nivedita Narain, and Michael Walton. Harvard Kennedy School working paper.

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

ETH4D Research Challenge Pilot Grant (\$24,500)	2026–2027
ETH Postdoctoral Research Fellowship, Research Fund (\$24,500)	2025–2027
Foreign Language and Area Studies (FLAS) Dissertation Fellowship (\$38,000)	2022
Dissertation Grant, Center on Contemporary India, UC Berkeley (\$15,000)	2022
APSA Minority Fellowship (\$2,000)	2019
3ie Grant for Qualitative Study on Sustainability of Self-Help Groups under the National Rural Livelihoods Mission (\$91,960)	2019
Center for Race and Gender Research Grant, UC Berkeley (\$2,000)	2019
Research Grant, Institute of International Studies, UC Berkeley (\$2,000)	2019
Center for the Politics of Development Grant, UC Berkeley (\$20,000)	2018–2023
Mossavar-Rahmani Center for Business and Government Winter Grant, Harvard Kennedy School	2015
Degree Student Program Winter Grant for Second Year Policy Analysis, Harvard Kennedy School	2015
International Development Grant, Harvard Kennedy School	2014
John F. Kennedy Full Tuition Fellowship, Harvard Kennedy School	2013–2015

Teaching Experience

South Asian Politics	Fall 2024
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Pradeep Chhibber; undergraduate-level</i>	
Quantitative Analysis in Political Research - Causal Inference	Fall 2020
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Thad Dunning; Ph.D.-level</i>	
Gender and International Human Rights	Spring 2020, 2021
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Helene Silverberg; undergraduate-level</i>	
The Varieties of Capitalism: The Political-Economic Systems of the World	Fall 2019
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Steven Vogel; undergraduate-level</i>	

Research and Professional Experience

University of California, Berkeley	Jan.–Aug. 2025
<i>Graduate Student Researcher for Cecilia Mo</i>	
Cleaned and analyzed data from a survey experiment on gender bias in U.S. presidential elections.	
World Bank, South Asia Region Gender Innovation Lab (SARGIL)	Apr. 2023–Sept. 2024
<i>Short-Term Consultant</i>	
University of California, Berkeley	Sept. 2022–May 2023
<i>Graduate Student Researcher for Cecilia Mo</i>	
<i>Metaketa Women's Groups RCT</i>: developed survey instruments and training curricula and coordinated with partner organizations for women's-group trainings on political participation in Nigeria. - Liaised in Abuja with research partners, including Innovations for Poverty Action and implementing partner ActionAid.	

Precision Development (PxD), Gujarat**June–Dec. 2022***Research Consultant*

- *Mapping Gaps in Rural Women's Well-Being*, in partnership with the SEWA Cooperative Federation and funded by Wellspring.
- Designed and conducted focus-group discussions, participatory mapping, and other qualitative and mixed-methods research to identify gaps in women's well-being, agricultural information, and livelihood needs in two districts of Gujarat.
- Generated evidence on potential mobile-based interventions and the scalability of information-delivery models.

World Bank**Jan.–Feb. 2022***Short-Term Consultant for Vijayendra Rao*

- Conducted a literature review on women's self-help groups in the developing world.

University of California, Berkeley**Summer 2020***Graduate Student Researcher for Cecilia Mo*

- *Natural Disasters and Political Trust in Nepal*: reviewed scholarship on the relationship between natural disasters and political trust across multiple settings.
- *Decision Dilemmas*: analyzed online survey-experiment data in Stata.

University of California, Berkeley**Spring 2019***Graduate Student Researcher for Alison Post*

- *City Size, Political Attitudes, and Participation*: used public-opinion and values data to study political attitudes, participation, and city size in Brazil, India, and Indonesia in R.

IMAGO Global Grassroots**Sept. 2017–June 2018***Research and Strategy Consultant, Gujarat and remote*

- Conducted research and strategy work on women's groups, NGOs, and organizational growth.
- *Transform Rural India*: analyzed baseline-survey data on women's political, economic, and social agency in program districts in North India to inform the organization's theory of change.
- *Self-Employed Women's Association*:
 - Documented governance and data use through focus-group discussions and in-depth interviews in rural Gujarat.
 - Trained staff and members in participatory data collection for organizational and program planning.
 - Designed and piloted an organization-wide livelihoods survey to track indicators for SEWA members across fourteen Indian states.
- Contributed to organization-building and scaling strategy for IMAGO as a global social-justice organization.

IDinsight India**Aug. 2015–2017***Manager*

- Managed research projects on women's livelihoods, water and sanitation, and health.
- *Andhra Pradesh Rural Inclusive Growth Programme*, Society for the Elimination of Rural Poverty, Andhra Pradesh Ministry of Rural Development; funded by the World Bank:
 - Designed and managed the measurement strategy and process interviews, including focus-group discussions and in-depth interviews with women and farmers.
 - Conducted sectoral reviews of farmer and livestock-producer groups, rural value chains, and rural retail chains.
 - Liaised with government officials on implementation and monitoring and evaluation systems.
- *CEPT University Center for Water and Sanitation*; funded by the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation: managed the design of WASH process- and impact-evaluation strategies for the municipalities of Wai and Sinnar, Maharashtra.
- *New Incentives*; funded by GiveWell: designed an analysis plan to test how conditional cash-transfer amounts affected infant measles vaccination in Nigeria.
- Conducted client-development interviews.

Busara Center for Behavioral Economics, Nairobi and Kisumu, Kenya**June–Aug. 2014***Research Associate for Johannes Haushofer and Jeremy Shapiro*

- *Domestic Violence Implications of Unconditional Cash Transfers*: analyzed data and designed and piloted focus-group questionnaires for men's and women's groups in western Kenya.
- Conducted outreach to multilateral organizations, NGOs, and government officials to launch the organization's

consultancy arm.

- Managed the client relationship and intervention design for ZanaAfrica, including pricing experiments and behavioral interventions to increase uptake of sanitary pads among low-income women in Kenya.

Affordable Housing Institute, Boston

Sept. 2012–June 2013

Associate

- Examined case studies from UN-ESCAP's pro-poor, community-based partnership waste-management programs in Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Vietnam, and Cambodia.
- Conducted field research and business development in Nicaragua to launch a hybrid value-chain entity expanding access to affordable housing finance for home improvement.
- Researched and co-authored green papers and development plans on affordable housing and finance for the Municipality of Ulaanbaatar (World Bank), Government of Haiti (Oxfam America), and Real Estate Development Fund of Saudi Arabia (Ernst & Young).

J-PAL South Asia

Aug. 2011–2012

Research Associate for Karthik Muralidharan, Paul Niehaus, and Sandeep Sukhtankar

- *Building State Capacity: Evidence from Biometric Smartcards in India*: managed operations for a large-scale randomized controlled trial involving 8,000 households and 150 survey and data-entry staff across eight districts.
- Hired, trained, and supervised field and data-entry staff and managed finances, budgets, and project planning.
- Designed survey instruments; supervised data entry in real time; and cleaned, validated, and managed large survey datasets in Stata.
- Co-authored donor reports
- Meetings with senior bureaucrats in the Government of Andhra Pradesh Department of Rural Development to track randomization and program implementation.
- *Biometric Authentication in the Public Distribution System in Bihar*: Pilot and scoping interviews with Public Distribution System shop owners and beneficiaries in Patna to understand ration delivery for below-poverty-line households.

Fieldwork

Gujarat, India (15 months)	July 2019; Mar.–Apr. 2022; Aug.–Oct. 2022; Jan.–Feb. 2023; Oct. 2023; Mar.–May 2024; July–Sept. 2024
Gujarat, India (remote; 5 months)	Nov. 2023–Mar. 2024
Abuja, Nigeria	July–Aug. 2022
Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, and Jharkhand, India	Summer 2019
Gujarat, India	Aug.–Dec. 2017
Delhi, India	2016–2017
Andhra Pradesh, India	2015–2016
Nairobi and Kisumu, Kenya	Summer 2014
Andhra Pradesh, India	2011–2012
Bihar, India	Summer 2011

Affiliations and Service

Research Associate, Center for the Politics of Development	2018–Present
Mentor, Equity in Policy Education	2021–2023
Mentor, Center for the Politics of Development Fellowship	2020–2021; 2022–2023
Representative, Women in Political Science, UC Berkeley	2020–2021
Graduate Student Coordinator, Comparative Politics Colloquium, UC Berkeley	2020–2021

Methods, Software, and Languages

Programming and software: R, Python, Stata, Qualtrics, ArcGIS, $\text{\LaTeX}$, z-Tree, MAXQDA

Languages: English (native), Gujarati (native), Hindi (advanced), Spanish (intermediate)